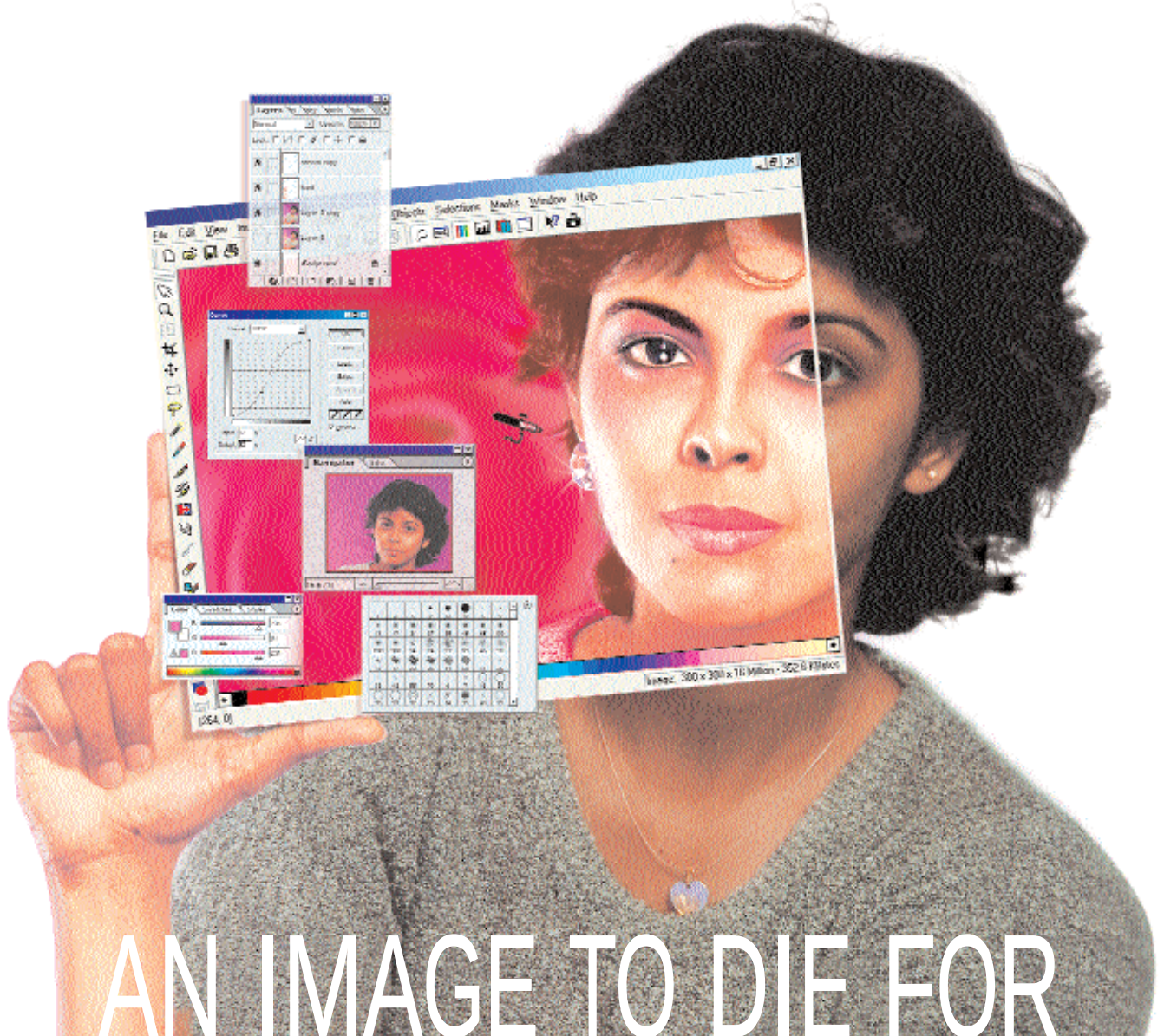


IN TEST: 5 IMAGE EDITING SOFTWARE



AN IMAGE TO DIE FOR

Want to put a glow on your friend's head? How about changing the colour of his shirt? Welcome to the world of image editors

MITUL MEHTA

A bike that looks more like a cheetah, a sepia tinge to a recently shot picture...we've all seen such fine examples of designing finesse in print advertisements. Designer's artistic prowess aside, the real accolades belong to the digital imagery software, which, with its extreme ease of use, can make any novice feel like a professional.

If you're eyeing the designing bandwagon you'll find an entire range of image editing software in the market. Some of these are targeted at the amateur user who just crops images or applies filter effects to photographs, while others are targeted at professionals working with multiple photographs at the same time in a

single window, changing colour tones, masking images, and much more. Of late, software developers are integrating Web animation features in image editing software, a clear indication that they want to include Web designers in their client list.

We tested five image editing software: Adobe Photoshop 6.01, Gimp 1.2, Micrografx Picture Publisher 9, Paint Shop Pro 7 and QFX 7.

As a selection criteria, we chose software that provided features such as layers, filters, photo enhancing capabilities, support for common file saving formats such as JPEG, TIFF, GIF, etc as these criteria set apart a professional image editing software from a basic one.